

mechanisms including several data export types including raw data, charts, or scheduled reports.

Self-hosting — several industries still lack capabilities to upload data to the cloud, this is why they might be interested in hosting all of their software offers on-site and in managed private installations.

SLA — this concerns with the vendor policies. In the case of the API you want to monitor two metrics: uptime — e.g., the promise that the service will be available 99.9% of the time, and the response time — how fast the API handles requests.

Support — for SaaS (Software as a service) companies, the importance of support lies with response time based on the issue severity. The second is the medium used when dealing with issues such as email, phone, live chat and more. When the API is critical, you want to ensure that the plan you subscribe to has good response times and phone on-demand support option.

Other APIs that can be used

Automation: The beauty of using an automation service is that you don't need to get busy writing code to be able to access the potential of APIs in your business. There are tools available that can help you automate business processes by using APIs for you. For example, you could add any site customer to an email marketing list and group them based on their buying histories and communications in future towards products you know they are interested in.

Security APIs: The internet is an extremely dangerous place for an online store without any security. There are many users with malicious intentions who are always looking for vulnerable websites and users. A recent report showed that in America alone that \$445 billion is lost annually due to security breaches and frauds. With the expansion of internet accessibility and applications, we can only expect this value to increase in the coming years.

Since customers are more internet-savvy. They avoid websites that do not have security assurances like SSL security certificates. Nobody wants to risk having their credit card details copied or their laptops infiltrated by malware.

A good way to prevent this is by using an authentication API. A good example of such API is OAuth 2.0 that is a token-based authorisation program. While the OAuth does not provide a specific protocol for authentication, it does provide the framework for authentication commands and mechanisms.